

The numbers tell the tale

The chart shown on the previous page illustrates the concerns that people these days have when it comes to the security of their digital data (Consumer confidence about personal online data security 2019, Published by Joseph Johnson on Statista). Out of the 10,063 respondents who took part in the survey, whose results we can see here in the chart that just 8 per cent answered that they have no concerns. The rest 92 per cent, meaning over 9,200 people, have some or the other concern regarding the safety of their data, which is there circulating online or is stored there.

To prove that it is not just the people who are paranoid, and getting worried without any reason, another study shows, that in 2019, 9.9 billion US Dollars were invested in privacy and security companies (Investment in privacy and security companies worldwide 2010-2019, Published by Shanhong Liu on Statista). When compared to the year 2010, which is almost a decade ago, this investment amount stood at 1.7 billion US Dollars. It was almost 6 times increase in the investments in just a period of 10 years, which definitely shows that privacy concerns are a real thing.

When it comes to our own backyard, all over the country, cybercrimes have been on the rise. As per the data released by the National Crime Records Bureau, the cybercrime rate in India in the year 2020 stood at 3.7 (Crime Rate is calculated as Crime Incidence per one lakh of the population). This same number in 2019 stood at 3.3, which shows that even if steadily, cybercrimes have been on the rise. And, the motives of cybercriminals have also been diverse. As per the data from the same agency, it can be from anywhere from a prank to causing disrepute to stealing information. And these are just the recorded numbers. There are millions of cases of small-scale privacy violations, cybercrime that goes unregistered because either the people are scared of registering their complaints about some reason or the other, or the crime is carried out in such a fashion that it goes unnoticed for long periods of time.

Users are increasing, and so is the threat

As per the data published by the Statista Research Department, India stood at the top of the Instagram user count across the board, with a total of 180 million users from the country were recorded to be active on the platform. The same is the story with all the other platforms too. Just by the virtue of probability, this higher number of users on the